Secular Music Messages, Trends, and Places

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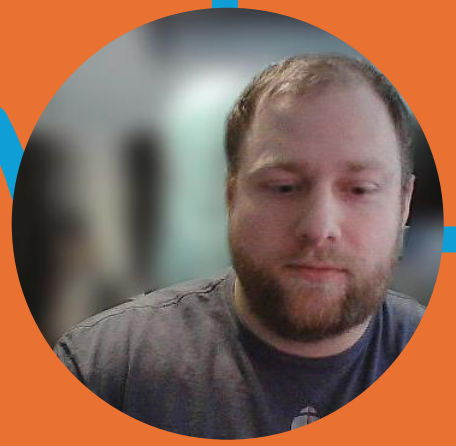
SPAN 110L



Music as a Reflection of Culture

- Latino culture is diverse and shaped by heritage, geography, and history

- Music expresses identity, adaptation, and pride

- Styles like salsa, merengue, and reggaeton show global influence

Celia Cruz The Queen of Salsa

- Expressed joy, pride, and Afro-Latino identity through music
- Songs like “La Vida es un Carnaval” celebrated resilience and life
- Broke barriers by performing in Spanish and embracing her heritage

Fania All Stars

- 1970s New York: Salsa becomes the sound of empowerment
- Embraced Afro-Latino identity and cultural pride
- United musicians across Latin America and the Caribbean

Daddy Yankee

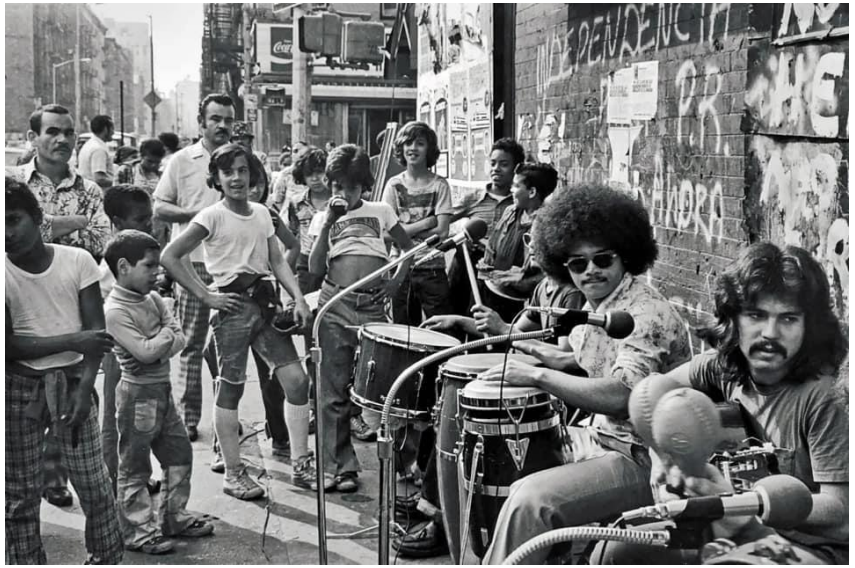
- Pioneered reggaetón’s rise from Puerto Rico to the world
- Promoted independence and ownership in Latin music
- Balanced global success with cultural roots

Ritchie Valens

- Among the first rock & rollers to embrace Latino heritage
- Blended Mexican rhythm and language with 1950s rock
- Opened mainstream paths for future Latino artists

Places That Shaped Latino Music

- San Juan, Puerto Rico
- New York City
- Havana, Cuba
- Los Angeles, California

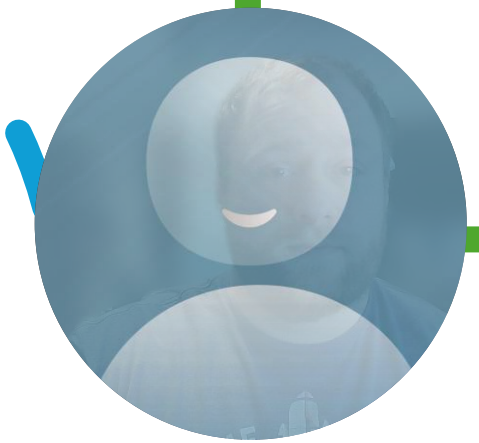


Conclusion

- Latino artists used music to express pride and resilience
- Styles evolved from local traditions to global influence
- Each generation redefined cultural identity through sound

Questions

- What message did Celia Cruz express through her music, and how did she break barriers in Latin entertainment?
- How did the Fania All Stars influence Latino identity and pride in 1970s New York?
- What made Daddy Yankee's career important for the business and independence of Latin music?
- Why is Ritchie Valens' song *La Bamba* considered a milestone in Latino representation in American music?
- How have Latino music styles like salsa, reggaetón, and rock influenced American culture as a whole?



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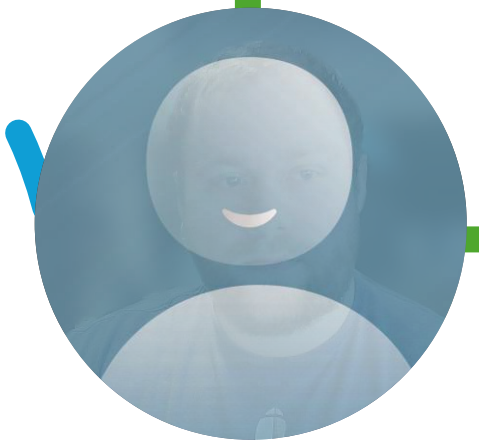

Thank you for your time!